MODULE 18 · DOMAIN 5 - CONFIGURATION AND KNOWLEDGE MANAGEMENT

Setting up a Project

Purpose first, the parts of a Project, what goes where, sharing safely, and one engagement per Project.

DOMAIN 5 of 7 EXAM WEIGHT 12% MODULE 18 of 33

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A Project is a workspace with a purpose, not a folder for everything.

Setting up a Project: the sequence

01

Purpose and users

What it is for, and who uses it.

02

Recurring tasks

The jobs it must do well, week after week.

03

Instructions and knowledge

Stable rules; current reference.

04

Test

Real past tasks; fix the gaps.

05

Share and maintain

Right people, right permissions, a review date.

ON THE EXAM

Purpose before instructions. Test before you share.

Writing the purpose statement

PART	HALDEN BID PROJECT
This Project helps...	Halden's twelve bid writers
to...	draft first answers to tender questions and check compliance
using...	method statements, past winning bids and the current rate card
following...	the house tender procedure and the client's word limits
It does not...	set prices, sign declarations, or handle Restricted data

THE TIEBREAKER

If you cannot write the purpose in five lines, the Project is not ready to build.

The parts of a Project

PART	WHAT IT HOLDS	HALDEN BID PROJECT
Instructions	Stable rules: role, standards, format	Bid assistant; British spelling
Knowledge	Current reference documents	Method statements, past bids
Project memory	What Claude learns in this Project	Kept apart from other Projects
Chats	Each person's conversations	Private unless shared
Skills, alongside	Repeatable procedures	House tender procedure

THE TIEBREAKER

Instructions shape every reply. Knowledge informs it. The prompt directs it.

What goes where

ITEM	WHERE IT BELONGS	WHY
Always use British spelling	Instructions	A rule for every reply
The current rate card	Knowledge	Reference that changes quarterly
This tender's question fourteen	The prompt	Today's specific job
Last year's winning bid	Knowledge	Reference to draw on
The deadline is Friday	The prompt	True only for this task
Answer in numbered paragraphs	Instructions	A format rule for every answer

ON THE EXAM

Stable rules: instructions. Current reference: knowledge. Today's specifics: the prompt.

Why the split matters

- **Rules buried in a knowledge file** are treated as reference, and can be missed.
- **Reference pasted into instructions** bloats them, and goes stale where nobody looks.
- **Task details in instructions** leak into every chat that follows.
- **One home per fact** makes maintenance a single edit, not a hunt.

> THE TIEBREAKER
>
> If a rule is broken, check the instructions. If a fact is wrong, check the knowledge.

Knowledge at scale: RAG for Projects

- **On paid plans, RAG switches on automatically** as project knowledge nears the context limit.
- **Up to ten times the capacity:** Claude retrieves the relevant parts instead of reading everything.
- **A visual indicator** shows when a Project is using RAG. There is no manual switch.
- **Retrieval finds what is there,** including superseded versions. Curation still matters.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> RAG raises the ceiling. It does not decide which version is current.

Sharing a Project: Team and Enterprise

VISIBILITY

Who can find it

- Public: everyone in the organisation can view and use it
- Private: only invited members
- Owners can turn sharing off

PERMISSION

What they can do

- View, or use: see contents and chat in it
- Edit: change instructions, knowledge, members
- Chats stay private unless shared one by one

THE TIEBREAKER

Sharing a Project shares the setup, not your chats. Give edit rights to the few who maintain it.

Projects and memory

- **Each Project keeps its own memory,** separate from other Projects and from your other chats.
- **Search past chats stays inside the Project boundary.** It never reaches across Projects.
- **Project memory is not knowledge.** Anything the team relies on belongs in a document.
- **Incognito chats are not available inside Projects.** Off-the-record work happens outside them.

> THE TIEBREAKER
>
> The Project boundary is a memory boundary. Use it deliberately.

One Project, or several?

SITUATION	DECISION	WHY
A new client engagement	New Project	Its material and memory stay with it
A new task, same team, same rules	Same Project	Shared rules and reference already there
Different audience or different rules	Separate Project	Instructions would contradict each other
A one-off question	A chat	Nothing needs to persist

ON THE EXAM

Split when the rules, the audience or the confidentiality boundary changes.

Quirk 7: two clients, one Project

- **Context bleed:** material for one client can surface in a draft for its competitor.
- **Confidentiality:** anyone with access to the Project sees both clients' material.
- **Project memory mixes:** what Claude learns about one client carries into the other's chats.
- **The fix:** one engagement, one Project, each limited to that client's account team.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> An instruction saying "keep them separate" is not separation. Separate Projects are.

Test before you share

- **Run three to five real recurring tasks** from recent weeks, not invented examples.
- **Check against criteria:** rules followed, facts correct, format right.
- **Check it uses the knowledge:** ask which document each key fact came from.
- **Fix one thing at a time,** re-run the same tasks, then share.

> THE TIEBREAKER
>
> A Project that has never met a real task is a draft, not a tool.

Project set-up traps

THE TRAP	WHY IT FAILS
Uploading files before defining the purpose	No idea what good looks like
Rules hidden in a knowledge file	Treated as reference, and missed
This week's deadline in the instructions	Leaks into every later chat
Two competing clients in one Project	Context bleed and confidentiality risk
Edit rights for everyone	Instructions change without anyone knowing
Sharing before testing on real tasks	Everyone meets the flaws at once

ON THE EXAM

Every trap puts something in the wrong place, or the wrong people in the room.

> Halden's bid manager wants every tender answer drafted in the bid Project to use British spelling, numbered paragraphs and the client's word limit.
>
> These rules apply to every answer, in every tender.

Where should these requirements go?

A In a knowledge file called style notes

B Typed into every prompt by each writer

C In the Project instructions

D In each writer's personal Memory

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Where should these requirements go?

A In a knowledge file called style notes

Rules in knowledge are treated as reference, and can be missed.

B Typed into every prompt by each writer

Relies on twelve people remembering, every time.

C In the Project instructions

Stable rules for every reply: instructions.

D In each writer's personal Memory

Personal, inconsistent, and invisible to the team.

THE SIGNAL

Applies to every answer in every tender: a stable rule, so instructions.

> Halden's finance team updates the rate card every quarter. Bid writers need the current prices when they draft pricing answers in the bid Project.

How should the rate card be handled?

A Copy every rate into the Project instructions

B Have each writer type the rates they need into their prompts

C Tell Claude to remember the rates in Memory

D Upload it as Project knowledge, and replace the old file each quarter

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

How should the rate card be handled?

A Copy every rate into the Project instructions

Bloats the instructions, and goes stale where nobody looks.

B Have each writer type the rates they need into their prompts

Manual, error-prone, and easy to use an old figure.

C Tell Claude to remember the rates in Memory

Personal recollection is no home for shared prices.

D Upload it as Project knowledge, and replace the old file each quarter

Current reference in knowledge, one version at a time.

THE SIGNAL

Reference that changes on a schedule: knowledge, with the old version removed.

> Quirk 7: Halden's customer success team keeps materials for two competing retail clients in one shared Project.
>
> A draft for one client recently mentioned the other client's promotion dates.

Which two actions best address the risk? Choose two.

A. Add an instruction telling Claude never to mix the two clients

B. Rename each file with the client's name

C. Merge both clients' material into one summary document

D. Create a separate Project for each client

E. Limit each Project's members to that client's account team

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which two actions best address the risk? Choose two.

A Add an instruction telling Claude never to mix the two clients

An instruction is not separation; the material is still there.

B Rename each file with the client's name

Labels help people, not separation.

C Merge both clients' material into one summary document

Mixes the material even more tightly.

D Create a separate Project for each client

Separates knowledge, memory and chats.

E Limit each Project's members to that client's account team

Limits who can see each client's material.

THE SIGNAL

Bleed has already happened: separate the Projects, and limit who is in each.

Halden's bid manager is setting up a new bid Project for the twelve writers.

(1) Share the Project with the bid team.

(2) Define the Project's purpose and who will use it.

(3) List the recurring tasks it must support.

(4) Add instructions and current reference knowledge.

(5) Test it on real past tender questions and fix the gaps.

What is the correct order?

A 3, 2, 4, 5, 1

B 2, 4, 3, 5, 1

C 2, 3, 4, 1, 5

D 2, 3, 4, 5, 1

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the correct order?

A 3, 2, 4, 5, 1

Lists tasks before the purpose is defined.

B 2, 4, 3, 5, 1

Writes instructions before knowing the tasks.

C 2, 3, 4, 1, 5

Shares before testing.

D 2, 3, 4, 5, 1

Purpose, tasks, set-up, test, share.

THE SIGNAL

Purpose first, share last, and test before you share.

> Halden's operations manager built the weekly report Project. Regional managers should be able to use it, but not change its instructions or knowledge.
>
> One manager asks whether sharing will expose the operations manager's own chats.

Which sharing set-up fits best?

A Give every regional manager edit rights

B Make the Project public, with edit rights for the whole organisation

C Share it privately with regional managers at the view-and-use level, and keep edit rights with the maintainers

D Keep the Project private, and share individual chats with each manager

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which sharing set-up fits best?

A Give every regional manager edit rights

Lets anyone change the instructions.

B Make the Project public, with edit rights for the whole organisation

The widest audience, with the most power to change it.

C Share it privately with regional managers at the view-and-use level, and keep edit rights with the maintainers

Use without edit; chats stay private anyway.

D Keep the Project private, and share individual chats with each manager

Sharing chats is not sharing the Project.

THE SIGNAL

Use, not change: the lower permission. And sharing never exposes chats.

> Halden's HR team loaded a large set of policies into its Project, and the RAG indicator is showing. Both the 2024 and 2026 sickness policies are uploaded.
>
> Some answers quote the 2024 version.

What is the best fix?

A Switch RAG off so Claude reads every document in full

B Remove superseded versions so only current, authoritative documents remain, then test with known questions

C Upload even more HR documents to improve coverage

D Switch to a more capable model for HR questions

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the best fix?

A Switch RAG off so Claude reads every document in full

There is no manual switch, and it would not fix the cause.

B Remove superseded versions so only current, authoritative documents remain, then test with known questions

Retrieval finds what is there: keep only the current version.

C Upload even more HR documents to improve coverage

More documents, more chances to retrieve the wrong one.

D Switch to a more capable model for HR questions

Any model can only use what it retrieves.

THE SIGNAL

Old and new versions both uploaded: curate the knowledge, then test.

In five lines

- **Purpose and recurring tasks first,** then instructions and knowledge, then test, then share.
- **Stable rules: instructions. Current reference: knowledge. Today's specifics: the prompt.**
- **RAG switches on by itself** for large knowledge on paid plans; curation still decides the version.
- **Share the setup, not chats:** view or use for most, edit for the maintainers.
- **One engagement, one Project:** no context bleed between clients.

COMING UP

Next: writing system-level instructions that work.